influx of outsiders or what the local tribals or adivasis called the *dikku*s. Commenting on the Hos tribe near Kolhan in 1914, one official observed that:[52]

> The Hos want to be left to themselves and the Kolhan to become fully a Ho reserve. Their hatred of the *dikku*s is as great as it was before. They will prefer a system that will exclude the *dikku*s from the Kolhan and they would appreciate much, if it were possible, to drive out the *dikku*s already settled there.

The dikkus, Bengalis, lungiwalas and ghair-mulkis were the ‘outsiders’ who caused deep resentment in the places they settled in even though their settings and contexts were quite different. But interestingly enough, migrants did not cause resentment everywhere they went in India. Why did nativist movements start in some parts of India and not others?

There are several reasons that appear to explain the emergence of nativist movements in India. In many places, the demographic impact of migration from outside a cultural region was quite severe and rapid, invoking local anxieties. Cultural differences were usually highlighted for only those migrant groups that commanded a higher social status than the locals, and especially during bouts of economic stagnation or when there was competition for limited resources. According to political scientist Myron Weiner (1931–99), who studied India’s nativist movements in great detail, ‘nativist movements convert cultural differences into cultural conflicts’.[53] These conflicts were particularly stark when cross-cultural mobility was relatively unknown to the locals. Nativist movements rarely occurred in regions which themselves experienced outmigration, such as Gujarat or Punjab, which also received a large number of internal migrants.

Not all anti-migrant policies need to be nativist as they can be formulated on considerations of the resources at hand, fiscal or ecological. Nativism arises when there is a conflict between the social mobility of the native population and the spatial mobility of the migrants. But nativism more often than not is a convenient ruse for political gain, based on little or faulty evidence. To ignore the contribution of migrants is to forgo a tremendous